Table S2. ZMEG $(CA)_n$ tract length and H-x-H motif preservation, within and across species.

Strain / species	$(CA)_n$ units	H-x-H preserved	Note
Within D. melanogaster (population strains; ZMEG (CA)n microsatellite)			
D. melanogaster dm6 (ISO1, ref.)	9	Y	reference assembly
OreR / w1118 (lab)	9	Y	identical to reference
Denmark (DK)	6	Y	6-bp in-frame deletion (tract shortened)
Spain (ES)	8	Y‡	2- & 1-bp indels (frameshift)
Finland (FI)	6	Y	6-bp in-frame deletion (tract shortened)
Sweden (SE)	10	Y‡	2-bp deletion (frameshift)
Turkey (TR)	8	Y‡	2- & 1-bp indels (frameshift)
Ukraine (UA)	9	Y	identical to reference
Zambia (ZI)	8	Y‡	2- & 1-bp indels (frameshift)
Across Drosophila (syntenic orthologues; His-x-H triple)			
D. melanogaster	9	Y	~0 Mya; reference
D. simulans	6	Y	~3-5 Mya; strong
D. sechellia	7	Y	~3-5 Mya; strong
D. mauritiana	9	Y	~3-5 Mya; strong
D. yakuba	7	Y	~10-13 Mya; strong
D. erecta	5	Y	~10-13 Mya; strong
D. ananassae	0	N	~15-20 Mya; moderate; tract collapsed
D. pseudoobscura	5	N	~25 Mya; partial; ORF truncated pre-tract
D. virilis	0	N	~40-50 Mya; fragmentary; ORF truncated pre-tract

$(CA)_n$ units = number of CA dinucleotide repeats at the syntenic ZMEG locus (single-assembly counts; short tracts are indel-assembly-sensitive). ‡ = tract present but frameshifted (H-x-H encoded in DNA, out of the ZMEG reading frame).

Within-species: every population strain retains the $(CA)_n$ tract (6–10 units). Across species: the $(CA)_n$→His-x-H triple is conserved throughout the melanogaster subgroup (5–9 units) and lost deeper (ananassae tract collapsed; pseudoobscura / virilis ORF truncated before the tract).